

Manager Operations and Governance Handbook

ACCESS LEVEL: MANAGEMENT TIER

TIER 3 - MANAGER

This handbook outlines managerial procedures, operational protocols, administrative sign-off authorities, performance oversight, and team governance guidelines for Engineering Managers, Directors, and Department Leads at NovaTech Innovations.

1. Manager Responsibilities & Authority

Managers are responsible for directing operational workflows, maintaining project delivery velocity, managing personnel, and enforcing corporate policies within their business units. Managers hold direct approval authority for discretionary team spend up to \$15,000 per transaction.

2. Team Management & Capacity Planning

Managers must actively maintain balanced team capacity and monitor burn-down rates across operational cycles. Engineering and Product leads are required to ensure continuous operational staffing thresholds, maintaining a minimum 60% active engineering capacity during peak deployment windows.

3. Leave Approval Matrix

Managers evaluate leave requests in accordance with team operational needs. While employees accrue 20 days PTO, managers hold discretion over scheduling to prevent coverage gaps.

- **Standard PTO (1 to 3 days):** Can be approved directly by the immediate manager within 48 hours of request.
- **Extended PTO (4 to 10 days):** Requires manager review ensuring no more than 20% of team capacity is off concurrently.
- **Block PTO (Over 10 consecutive days):** Requires direct manager approval and secondary sign-off from the Department VP.
- **WFH Exceptions:** Managers may grant up to 5 additional remote days per quarter beyond standard staff limits for personal exceptions.

Access Hierarchy Note: Interns receive 1 day/mo, staff receive 20 days standard. This section specifies the approval rules enforced by management to govern those entitlements.

4. Performance Management & PIP Protocols

Managers are responsible for conducting structured bi-annual reviews and managing performance gaps proactively. When an employee consistently falls below expectations, the manager must initiate formal intervention:

- **Informal Coaching (4 Weeks):** Documented weekly 1-on-1 sessions identifying specific performance deficiencies.
- **Performance Improvement Plan (PIP):** A formal 30-to-60-day plan created in coordination with HR, defining 3–5 quantitative KPIs.
- **Evaluation:** Weekly milestone tracking. Failure to meet PIP targets results in termination subject to HR review.

5. Hiring, Headcount & Onboarding

Managers drive talent acquisition for their respective teams. All headcount requests must align with approved quarterly department budgets. The hiring workflow involves: submitting a Position Requisition Form (PRF) in the Management Portal, participating in candidate interviews, and approving final offer packages within authorized salary bands.

6. Departmental Budget Breakdown (Q3/Q4 Operational)

Managers oversee discretionary operational spend and software licensing budgets. The operational spending framework across core technology divisions is outlined below:

Department Division	Q3 Allocated Budget	Q4 Allocated Budget	Approval Threshold
Cloud Infrastructure & DevOps	\$420,000	\$480,000	Manager up to \$15k / VP above \$15k
Core Application Engineering	\$650,000	\$710,000	Manager up to \$15k / VP above \$15k
Data Security & Compliance	\$280,000	\$310,000	Manager up to \$15k / VP above \$15k

7. Project Approvals & Architecture Governance

Project expenditures under \$15,000 and standard technical architecture refactoring tasks require direct manager approval. Engineering changes that modify core database schemas, public API contracts, or third-party cloud vendors require approval from the Architecture Review Board (ARB) and Department VP.

8. Team Targets & OKR Alignment

Managers must translate enterprise strategy into measurable quarterly team OKRs. Objectives must be finalized and logged in the Management Dashboard no later than 5 business days prior to the start of each fiscal quarter.

9. Escalation & Incident Response Procedures

Managers serve as Tier-2 incident commanders during operational outages or security events. Incident response guidelines require managers to establish an active war room within 15 minutes of a Severity-1 event notification and provide bi-hourly status updates to executive leadership.

10. Operational Reporting Requirements

Managers are required to submit weekly operational status reports to Department Directors every Thursday by 5:00 PM. Reports must cover sprint velocity, budget burn rates, high-priority risks, headcount updates, and security compliance metrics.